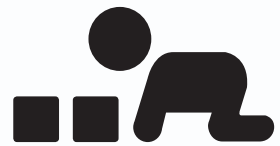


DAY CARE WORKER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Day care workers care for, educate, and supervise babies and young children at play, helping them to develop and learn. In this role, you are responsible for safeguarding the children and will encourage them to develop their numeracy, language, and social skills through games, activities, and excursions. Much of the work is with children under the age of five, but some nurseries offer after-school and care for older children.



SALARY

Day care assistant ★★★★★

Day care manager ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Growing sector in most parts of the world due to rapidly expanding population • Wide variety of employment options, including part-time and self-employed work

CAREER PATHS

Day care workers are employed in many settings—from public- and private-sector day care centers to playgroups and children's centers—so job prospects in this sector are good. Specialized areas, such as caring for children with disabilities or learning difficulties, require more training and certification.

DAY CARE ASSISTANT You can volunteer or work as a supervised day care assistant after high school, combining on-the-job experience with studying for a degree or certificate in childcare.

GRADUATE In some states, you will be required to earn an early childhood education certification before you can begin working in a day care center.



HOSPITAL DAY CARE WORKER

Works with hospitalized children up to the age of five, caring for the needs of newborn babies or using play as a means of helping older children to cope with illness or hospital treatments.



DAY CARE WORKER Most employers encourage you to continue your professional development, with courses in areas such as child welfare and preparing young children for school. With experience, you can specialize in different types of childcare.

